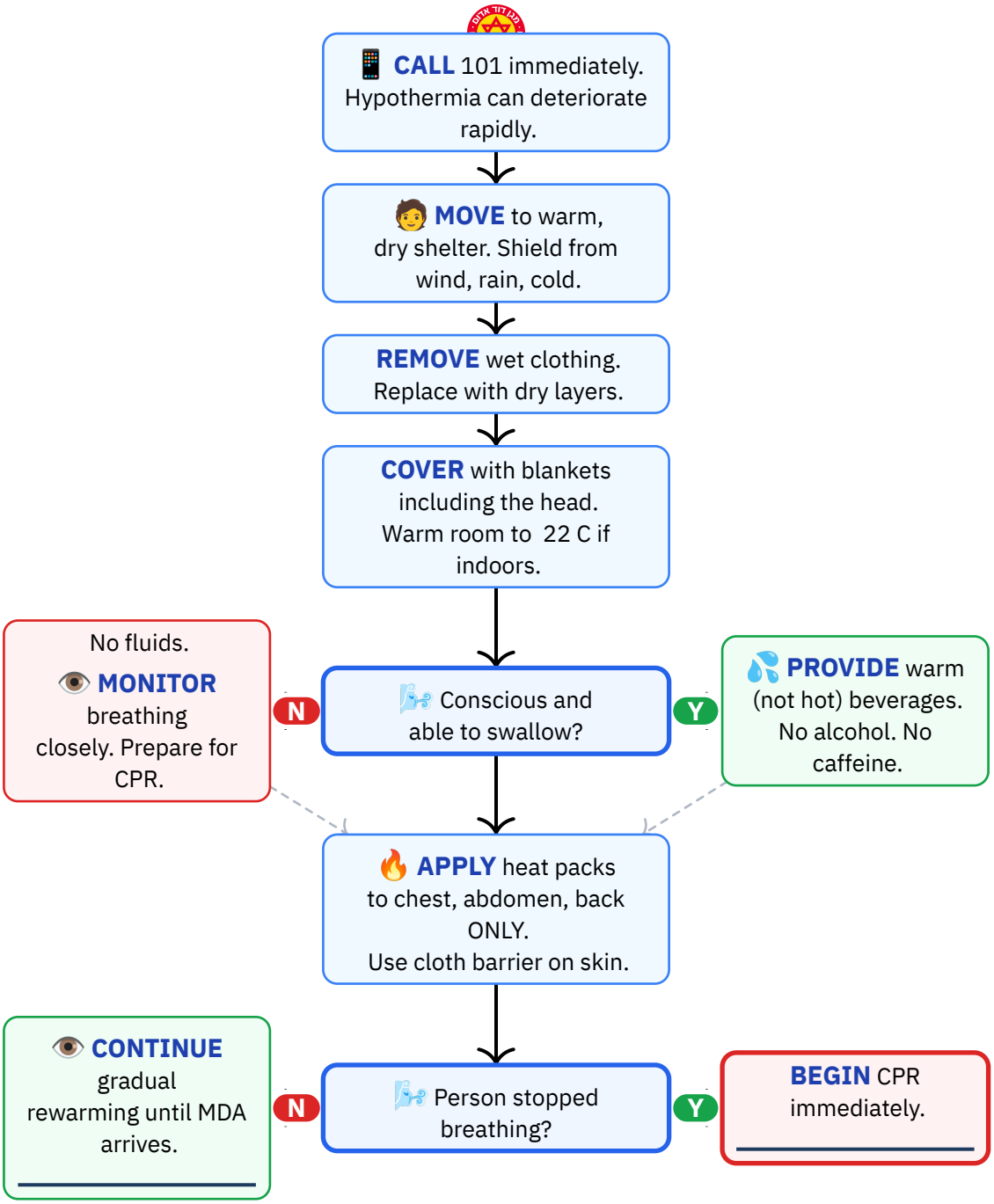

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Reference Notes

DO NOT:

✕ **Do NOT rub extremities** — friction can cause tissue damage and cardiac complications.
✕ **Do NOT use direct intense heat** (hot water baths, heating pads directly on skin) — rapid rewarming can cause dangerous cardiac arrhythmias.
✕ **Do NOT give alcohol** — it dilates blood vessels and accelerates heat loss.
✕ **Do NOT give caffeine** — it worsens hypothermia.
✕ **Do NOT warm extremities first** — cold blood rushing to the heart can trigger cardiac arrest (afterdrop).
✕ **Do NOT apply vigorous external rewarming** — gradual rewarming is essential.

Equipment needed:

— Blankets or thermal blankets (space blankets)
— Dry clothing
— Heat packs with cloth barrier
— Warm (not hot) beverages (for conscious patients only)

Hebrew Terminology — מונחים בעברית

English	עברית	Pronunciation
Hypothermia	היפותרמיה	hi-po-TER-mi-ya
Cold exposure	חשיפה לקור	kha-shi-FA la-KOR
Shivering	רעד	RA-ad
Blanket	שמיכה	smi-KHA
Warm drink	משקה חם	mash-KE KHAM
Unconscious	מחוסר הכרה	me-khu-SAR ha-ka-RA
Breathing	נושם	no-SHEM
Ambulance	אמבולנס	am-bu-LANS
Emergency	חירום	khe-RUM
Are you cold?	קר לך?	KAR le-KHA?
Cover him/her	תכסו אותו/אותה	tekh-SU o-TO / o-TA

Source: Magen David Adom (MDA) — MDA Emergency Medicine Manual 2024
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